

Chapter 173-3

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After learning that Sun Chengcheng was behind it, everything made sense.

After all, stepping on a fellow actress after working together was something she was quite skilled at.

It's just that before she stepped on people directly, and now she had switched to a different method.

Liang Shi wasn't in a hurry to resolve this matter. She first went to ask Gu Yixue.

Gu Yixue wasn't concerned. For her, box office revenue was just a bonus anyway.

She had never planned to get rich off box office earnings.

However, having someone from the same production cause this kind of trouble was indeed vexing.

It felt like being stabbed in the back.

Yet Gu Yixue couldn't come forward to say anything, especially since Sun Chengcheng had done all this behind the scenes.

It wasn't exactly lying either.

It's just that Liang Shi's identity, which she had hidden for so long, was suddenly exposed, so she had to acknowledge it.

It was frustrating, but there was no other choice.

Liang Shi had Chang Hui release a statement, but it was just a drop in the bucket.¹

It didn't make the public opinion completely dissipate.

It was later that Liang Xinzhou registered a Weibo account overnight, got it verified, and then posted a pinned message.

@Liang Xinzhou: Liang Shi's surname is Liang, right? @Liang Shi.

Publicly showing his support for Liang Shi.

His second Weibo post was: Liang Xinran's surname is also Liang. @Liang Xinran.

This was essentially telling everyone: They're both my sisters, there's no need to compete.

Meanwhile, Chang Hui's PR team also took action, guiding the narrative online and steering public opinion toward "having your life switched at birth wasn't something she wanted either."

The matter finally settled down, but Liang Shi's identity could no longer be hidden.

Everyone started examining her interactions with Liang Xinran on the variety show under a magnifying glass.

In any case, she was trending on hot search every day—the production team didn't even need to buy it.

Fortunately, "Journey of the Heart" wasn't affected much.

Liang Shi arranged to meet with Sun Chengcheng.

At that time, Sun Chengcheng had just announced an endorsement deal and simultaneously announced a drama—an S+ project from a well-known team.

She was doing quite well for herself.

After all, in the original world, with her level, she probably couldn't even get a supporting female role in an S+ project, let alone the female lead.

When Liang Shi saw her, she first leisurely poured a cup of tea, her eyes lowered, looking very gentle.

"What do you want with me?" Sun Chengcheng asked. "There shouldn't be anything for us to talk about, right?"

Liang Shi smiled lightly: "Is that so?"

Sun Chengcheng froze for a moment, then continued with a cold face: "What else?"

"Sun Chengcheng." Liang Shi stared at her. "You've become more and more skilled at throwing dirty water on fellow actresses in your productions."

Sun Chengcheng's expression changed slightly but quickly recovered. She played dumb to the end: "What are you talking about? I don't understand."

Liang Shi sneered: "You don't need to understand."

As soon as the words left her mouth, a cup of tea was splashed on Sun Chengcheng's face, catching her completely off guard.

Sun Chengcheng was stunned, then screamed. But Liang Shi leisurely adjusted her sleeve, and a few seconds later, another cup of tea was splashed over.

Tea leaves stuck to Sun Chengcheng's face.

"Liang Shi! Have you gone crazy?!" Sun Chengcheng shouted.

Liang Shi nodded, smiled, her eyes carrying a mocking gleam: "The first cup is a toast to you for the previous exposé, stepping on me by claiming I sexually harassed you."

Sun Chengcheng's eyes immediately changed. "You... you you..."

She was so shocked that she couldn't even complete her sentences.

But Liang Shi continued with a smile on her lips: "The second cup is a toast to you for exposing my identity this time, stepping on a fellow actress again during the release of 'Journey of the Heart.'"

Sun Chengcheng was so stunned she couldn't speak.

But Liang Shi raised her hand and splashed another cup.

"I used to think that taking a step back would lead to a broader horizon."² Liang Shi smiled lightly. "But now I've realized that when I take a step back, you just push forward even more."

"This cup is a warning to you. If there's a next time, I will definitely make you leave the industry for good." Liang Shi set the teacup down heavily on the table. "I'm different from before. You know that."

"So what?!" Sun Chengcheng shouted. "You just married the heiress of Minghui Jewelry! Without Dongheng's protection, what are you?! What gives you the right to make me leave the industry?!"

"Just the fact that I married the heiress of Minghui Jewelry... no wait, she's now the CEO of Minghui Jewelry." Liang Shi said. "To deal with a minor celebrity, isn't Minghui Jewelry enough? Do I even need Dongheng? Do you think you're worthy of that?"

Sun Chengcheng: "....."

"You... you knew I was Sun Chengcheng from the beginning, didn't you?" Sun Chengcheng suddenly realized.

"Yes, from the moment I first saw you." Liang Shi said. "Because a detestable aura can't be hidden."

Sun Chengcheng was shocked, but a few seconds later, Liang Shi suddenly smiled: "Oh right, your career ends today."

"What do you mean?" Sun Chengcheng was confused.

Liang Shi waved her phone. "See for yourself."

After saying this, Liang Shi stood up to leave. Sun Chengcheng quickly glanced at her phone and saw a trending topic: #Sun Chengcheng Breach of Contract#.

Gu Yixue had directly had her studio's legal team send a lawyer's letter. When Gu Yixue signed contracts with actors, it included a clause that during the release period of "Journey of the Heart," they could not do anything detrimental to the film.

This was something Gu Yixue always included in her contracts—covering illegal activities, moral corruption, chaotic private life, backstabbing colleagues in the same production, unauthorized marketing purchases, and so on.

And Sun Chengcheng had breached the contract.

At the same time, someone leaked that Sun Chengcheng had been frequenting a certain club—a place notorious for being a male escort establishment.³

This added another label of "chaotic private life" to her name.

Sun Chengcheng was shocked: "No... I only went there to find someone."

Liang Shi smiled: "That I wouldn't know."

Sun Chengcheng's eyes were practically bulging: "Liang Shi! You!"

"Give someone a taste of their own medicine."⁴ Liang Shi stood up, her tone becoming increasingly nonchalant. "I originally wanted to give you a chance to start over here, but you had no such intention. So let it end at the beginning."

After saying this, she walked out.

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1. "杯水車薪" (a cup of water to put out a burning cart of firewood) is a Chinese idiom meaning an utterly inadequate measure or a drop in the bucket. ⇐
 2. "退一步海闊天空" is a Chinese proverb meaning "take a step back and the sea and sky will open up"—essentially, yielding or being tolerant will lead to better outcomes. ⇐
 3. "鴨子店" literally means "duck shop." In Chinese slang, "鴨子" (duck) refers to male escorts or male prostitutes, similar to how "雞" (chicken) is slang for female prostitutes. ⇐
 4. "以其人之道還治其人之身" is a Chinese idiom meaning to use someone's own methods against them—essentially, to give someone a taste of their own medicine. ⇐